INCH-POUND

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MIL-STD-1609C
21 May 1990

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE
STANDARD PRACTICE

PROVISIONS FOR EVALUATING QUALITY

OF

WOMEN'S SKIRTS

AMSC N/A

FSC 8410

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FOREWORD

1. This standard is approved by all Department and Agencies of the Department of Defense (DoD).

2. This standard is intended to provide standard practice for quality inspections of women's skirts. This standard provides the following information:

- A standard method for visually inspecting and evaluating the quality of women's skirts.
- Standard descriptions for skirts defects.
- Standardized examination requirements for skirts.

3. Comments, suggestions, or questions on this document should be sent to trpsptctstandardiz@dla.mil. Since contact information can change, you may want to verify the currency of this address information using ASSIST at https://assist.dla.mil.

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1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This standard covers the inspection provision requirements for skirts worn by female members of the military.

2. APPLICABLE PUBLICATIONS

2.1 General. The publications listed in this section are specified in sections 3, 4 and 5 of this standard. This section does not include documents cited in other sections of this standard or recommended for additional information or as examples. While every effort has been made to ensure the completeness of this list, document users are cautioned that they must meet all specified requirements of publications cited in sections 3, 4 and 5 of this standard whether or not they are listed.

2.2 Government publications. N/A

2.2.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following other Government publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these publications are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

2.3 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these publications are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF TEXTILE CHEMISTS AND COLORISTS (AATCC)

AATCC Photographic Seam Smoothness Scales - 68373

(Copies are available at https://www.aatcc.org.)

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR QUALITY (ASQ)

ASQ/ANSI Z1.4 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

(Copies of this publication are available online at https://asq.org or https://ansi.org.)

ASTM INTERNATIONAL

ASTM D3990 - Standard Terminology Relating to Fabric Defects
ASTM D6193 - Standard Practice for Stitches and Seams

(Copies of these publications are available online at https://www.astm.org.)

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SDL ATLAS

Fabric Replica Defect Scales
Part Number 402985 – Slub/Knot Replica Set

(Replica set is available for purchase from SDL Atlas Customer Service, 1-803-329-2110).

2.4 Order of precedence. Unless otherwise noted herein or in the contract, in the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. DEFINITIONS

3.1 End-item. End-item refers to finished skirt, constructed, labeled, pressed and presented for acceptance. Other criteria may be specified in an end-item detailed specification (see 2.4).

3.2 Fabric defects. End-item fabric defects specified in Table I and are defined in ASTM D3990. The defects not specified in Table I are specified in the appropriate fabric specification.

3.3 Inside and outside. The terms “inside and outside” as used in this standard are defined as follows:

“Inside” refers to any part of the skirt that are not visible when the completely closed and fastened skirt (without a belt) are examined when laid flat on a table.

“Outside” refers to any part of the skirt that are visible when the completely closed (without a belt) and fastened skirt are examined when laid flat on a table.

3.4 Knots and slubs. Score only knots and slubs that exceed the limits specified in the basic cloth specification as defects when evaluating quality of the finished skirt. Knots and slubs are rated using Fabric Defect Replica Scales (see 2.3) .

3.5 Major defects. A departure of a quality characteristic from its intended level of the specification that occurs with sufficient severity that is likely to result in a failure, or to reduce considerably the usability of the skirt for its intended purpose. (See Table I).

3.6 Minor defects. A departure of a quality characteristic from its intended level of the specification but the service is still considered serviceable. (Multiple minor defects may render service caps or production lot unserviceable). (See Table I).

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TABLE I. End-item defects.

Defect Description	Dress		Semi-Dress	
	Major	Minor	Major	Minor
I. MATERIAL DEFECT AND DAMAGE				
Any hole, cut, tear, smash, burn, drill hole, scorched area and/or multiple float:				
- Up to 1/4-inch, inclusive	101		101	
- More than 1/4-inch in any direction	102		102	
Any knot and/or slub 1/		201		201
Mis weave, area of no dye penetration, dye, streak, missing yarn, broken yarn, visible mend, thin place, shade bar and barre		202		202
Loose yarn, snag and/or coarse yarn more than ½-inch in any direction on outside	103			203
Woven in spot or stain debris and/or waste on outside visible at 3-feet		203		204
II. SHADED PARTS				
Variation and shade within a part and/or between parts	104		103	
III. STITCHES, SEAM AND STITCHING DEFECTS				
Needle chew:				
- Up to 1/4-inch, inclusive, in any direction		204		205
- More than 1/4-inch in any direction	105		104	
Seam allowance not as specified		205		206
Raw edge of fabric not as specified (except where pinking is required)		206		207
Seams irregular, twisted, wavy and/or pleated	106			208
Wrong seam and/or stitch type	107		105	
Any line of stitching omitted	108		106	
Any line of stitching not starting and/or ending where specified		207		209
Basting stitch visible on outside of the finished skirts		208		210
Gauge irregular and/or not within range specified (score only when condition exists on more than ½-inch the length of the seam)		209		211
Stitches per inch incorrect		210		212
Loose stitch tension:				
- Up to 1/2-inch inclusive		211		213
- More than 3/4-inch	109		107	
Tight stitch tension (all seams)	110		108	
Seam puckered 2/ (score only on major portion of seam)	111		109	

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TABLE I. End-item defects. - Continued

Defect Description	Dress		Semi-Dress	
	Major	Minor	Major	Minor
III. STITCHES, SEAM AND STITCHING DEFECTS (continued)				
Any part of skirt caught in an unrelated operation and/or stitching	112		110	
End of stitching, when not caught in another seam, not backstitched as specified		212		214
Thread break not repaired by backstitching at least 1/2-inch		213		215
Ends of a continuous line of stitching not overlapped by at least 1/2-inch		214		216
Open seam (see 3.11.1) or runoff:				
- Up to and including 1/2-inch		215		217
- Greater than 1/2-inch	113		111	
Inseam and/or outseam not lapped as specified	114			218
Ends of inseams staggered at crotch more than 1/2-inch (center to center)	115			219
Pleated and/or twisted at base of pocket and/or placket opening	116			220
IV. COMPONENTS (when applicable)				
Any component omitted and/or part not as specified and/or twisted, unless otherwise specified below	117		112	
Thread/gimp				
Thread/gimp color not as specified	118		113	
Button				
Button not as specified, broken, cracked, bent		216		221
Snap fastener				
Not as specified	--	--	114	
Non-functioning, broken, cracked, bent	--	--	115	
Hook and eye/bar fastener				
Not as specified	119		116	
Non-functioning (broken, bent, cracked)	120		117	
Hook and loop fastener				
Not as specified	--	--	--	--
Non-functioning	--	--	--	--
Slide fastener				
Not as specified	121		118	
Cut, hole and/or tear in tape	122		119	
Slider does not operate smoothly (binds, catches and/or sticks)		217		222

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TABLE I. End-item defects. - Continued

Defect Description	Dress		Semi-Dress	
	Major	Minor	Major	Minor
IV. COMPONENTS (when applicable) (continued)				
Binding				
Material type and/or color not as specified		218		223
Not cut as specified (e.g., on the bias)		219		224
Width of finished binding not as specified		220		225
Waistband				
Waistband gripper tape not as specified		221		226
Label				
Not as specified (material)		222		227
Missing, incorrect and/or illegible information	123		120	
Braid/cord				
Braid/cord/stripes not as specified	124		121	
Fusing material				
Not as specified	125		122	
V. CONSTRUCTION				
Unless otherwise specified, items intended to be equal in length and/or in alignment that differ by more than 1/2-inch and 1/8-inch respectively.	126		123	
Any component part not cut and/or sewn in accordance with specified directional lines, twill lines and/or fabric grain not parallel between parts	127		124	
Excessive bulging, twisting, pulling and/or puckering at closures when fasteners and/or closure devices are properly positioned according to marks on patterns	128		125	
Notch exposed at pocket opening	129		126	
Top of pocketing not securely inserted under waistband causing bulge and distortion on the outside	130		127	
Pocketing caught in unrelated stitching	131		128	
Buttonhole				
Not as specified, location, omitted, added, not finished as specified	132		129	
Gimp omitted, uncut buttonhole, incomplete stitching	133		130	
Two (2) or more skipped and/or loose stitches		223		228
Button				
Misplaced, missing, insecurely sewn		224		229
Location not as specified		225		230
Number of buttons not as specified		226		231

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TABLE I. End-item defects. – Continued

Defect description	Dress		Semi-Dress	
	Major	Minor	Major	Minor
V. CONSTRUCTION (when applicable) (continued)				
Snap fastener				
Not attached as specified, missing	--	--	131	
Male and female sides misaligned by more than 1/8-inch when skirt are properly oriented	--	--		232
Hook and eye/bar fastener				
Not attached as specified	134		132	
Not positioned as specified causing bulging, puckering, twisting and/or pulling	135		133	
Hook and eye sides misaligned:				
- Misaligned by ≥ 1/4-inch	136		134	
Hook and loop fastener				
Not attached as specified	--	--	--	--
Hook and loop sides misaligned:				
- Misaligned by ≥ 3/4-inch	--	--	--	--
Bartack or tack				
Missing, insecure, misplaced, not serving intended purpose and/or not specified size and/or type:				
- Bartack for attachment	137		135	
- Bartack for reinforcement		227		233
Incorrect number of stitches		228		234
Loose and/or tight stitch tension		229		235
Waist adjustment strap or tab				
Not attached and/or finished as specified, missing	--	--	136	
Slide fastener				
Not attached as specified	138		137	
Opening greater than 1/8-inch at top when fully secured		230		236
Uneven at top by more than 1/4-inch	139		138	
Bottom stop not positioned within 3/8-inch of front seam		231		237
Stitching too close to chain not permitting slider to pass freely	140		139	
Slide fastener thong missing and/or incorrectly attached	--	--	--	--
Bottom stop not securely stapled	141		140	
Slide fastener thong				
Length of thong not as specified	--	--		238
End of thong not finished as specified	--	--		239
Binding				
Not attached and/or finished as specified	142		141	
Tight and/or twisted, causing puckering and/or pleating		232		240
More splices than specified		233		241

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TABLE I. End-item defects. – Continued

Defect description	Dress		Semi-Dress	
	Major	Minor	Major	Minor
V. CONSTRUCTION (when applicable) (continued)				
Waistband				
Width of finished waistband and linings not as specified		234		242
Waistband not uniformly stitched to top of skirt causing waviness, pleats, twist of waistband, and lining visible on outside.	143		142	
Waistband extension not specified distance from fold and/or welt to point of tab and/or underside exposed by 1/8-inch.		235		243
Linings not as specified and exposed on outside		236		244
Non-slip tape as specified	144		--	--
Waistband interlining/fusing not as specified, bubbling, delamination	145		--	--
Waist adjustment strap and/or tab missing	--	--	--	--
Belt loops				
Belt loops, missing and/or incorrect number	146		143	
Finished width and length not as specified		237		245
Not attached and/or finished as specified		238		246
Placement more than 1/4-inch from specified location		239		247
Opening differs from specified by more than ⅛-inch		240		248
Bartacks not as specified		241		249
Darts				
Darts stitched with twists and/or puckers, and/or not properly tapered and stitched closed to the very end of the folded edge, resulting in noticeable indentation and/or fullness on the outside of skirt	147		144	
Length of darts differs by more than 1/4-inch	148		145	
Front opening				
Opening orientation incorrect	149		146	
J stitch not as specified		242		250
Left fly facing exposed when slide fastener is closed	150		147	
Right fly facing exposed when slide fastener is closed		243		251
Slide fastener tapes show when the skirts are fully closed	151		148	

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TABLE I. End-item defects. – Continued

Defect Description	Dress		Semi-Dress	
V. CONSTRUCTION (when applicable) (continued)	Major	Minor	Major	Minor
Pockets or flap:				
General pocket information:				
Pocket and/or flap out of alignment from each other by more than 1/2-inch when intended to be in corresponding locations	152		149	
Poor pocket construction causing fullness and/or distortion	153		150	
Pocket openings uneven in length up to 1/4-inch		244		252
Raw edge of pocket opening exposed	154			253
Pocket flap not as specified, crooked, poorly shaped and/or constructed, not covering pocket opening	155		151	
Pocket bag material not as specified		245		254
Depth of pocket not as specified by more than 1/2-inch	156		152	
Pocket bag improperly sewn, causing fullness, twisting or bunching	157			255
Pocket bag material caught in an unrelated operation	158			256
Welt pocket information:				
Pocket opening welt not as specified	159		153	
Poorly shaped and/or not uniform in shape or size	160		154	
Irregular in-width by more than 3/16-inch	161		155	
Welts out of horizontal alignment with waistband when measured from bottom of waistband to top corners of welt up to 1/4-inch	162		156	
Finish depth and width of welt not as specified	163		157	
Welts out of alignment from each other when measured from the bottom waistband straight down to top edge of outside and inside end of welt by 1/4-inch	164		158	
Hip pocket information:				
Cord and/or welt not as specified width	--	--		257
Hip pocket cord and/or bearer not caught in the edge stitching of pocketing	--	--		258
Side pocket or hanging type pocket information:				
Pocketing facing too tight and/or loose causing edge of pocket opening to be wavy		246		259
Facing and/or bearer not caught in bartack at each end of opening; facing and/or bearer not extending below bottom bartack and above top bartack	165		159	
Pocketing notched more than 1/4-inch beyond width of outseam allowance on the underside		247		260
Bartack extends beyond outseam, no more than1/8-inch	--	--		261

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TABLE I. End-item defects. – Continued

Defect Description	Dress		Semi-Dress	
	Major	Minor	Major	Minor
V. CONSTRUCTION (when applicable) (continued)				
Hem				
Not finished as specified		248		262
Label				
Not as specified, missing, incorrect and/or illegible	166		160	
Braid/stripes (when required)				
Not as specified, missing	167		161	
Not completely caught in waistband seam	168		162	
Twisted, bulging, bunched and/or puckered	169		163	
Stripes not centered over outseam and not even with edge of side pocket				
VI. PRESSING AND CLEANING EFFECTS				
Pressing omitted and/or poorly pressed, and/or exhibiting a double crease line:				
- On permanent crease and/or durable press	170		164	
- On other than permanent crease and/or durable press	171			263
Permanent crease line not ending within specified limits	172		165	
Permanent crease omitted:				
- <1-inch	173		166	
Seam allowance not pressed open		249		264
Burned and/or scorched in pressing	174		167	
Gloss and/or impressions not removed		250		265
Any spot and/or stain that cannot be completely removed with a clean cloth moistened with water:				
Three (3) or more thread ends on the outside greater than or equal to 1/2-inch		251		266
Re-sewn and/or re-stitched seams not cleaned	175		168	
Thread end caught in a line of stitching on the outside for more than 1/4-inch		252		267

1/ Knots and slubs are rated in accordance with the Fabric Defect Replica Scales.
2/ Puckering is rated in accordance with the AATCC Photographic Seam Smoothness Scales. Puckering on major portions of the suspected seam that has a rating less than “4” will be scored as a puckered seam. (see 2.3).

3.7 Puckering. Puckering refer to the gathering of a seam and stitches during sewing and after sewing causing unacceptable seam appearance when compared to the AATCC Photographic Seam Smoothness Scales -68373 (see 2.3). The seams are to be examined according to 4.2. Seams scored as a puckered seam will have a rating no less than “4” for single or double needle seams.

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3.8 Defective button. A button will be considered defective when it is broken or cracked, has sharp, rough, cracked or split edges; has scratches or dents, blemishes, or foreign matter embedded; or is badly or unevenly shaded. Additional button defects will be found in Table I included in this document or in applicable button specifications.

3.9 Quality assurance terms and procedures. Definitions of quality assurance terms and procedures, where applicable, will be in accordance with ASQ/ANSI Z1.4.

3.10 Raw edge. Raw edges will be defined as any edge not finished, as specified, including any protruding edge on the outside of a skirt.

3.11 Stitches, seams and stitching defects. Unless otherwise specified, seams will be as defined in ASTM D6193. Open seam defects will be defined in (see 3.11.1).

3.11.1 Open seam. A seam will be considered open when one (1) or more stitches joining a seam are broken or runoff, or when two (2) or more continuous skipped stitches occur. Double stitched seams will be considered open when one (1) or both rows of stitching are open.

4. GENERAL REQUIREMENTS

4.1 General. This standard contains provisions and terminology for end-item inspection, examination, and dimensional examination for the women's skirt. If there are any inconsistencies between the requirements of the appropriate end-item specification and the provisions of this standard, the end-item specification shall govern.

4.2 Coverage. A standard shall be prepared to describe essential technical requirements for engineering or technical criteria, methods, processes, or practices. To the greatest extent possible, standards shall be written so that commercial practices and processes may be used to meet the requirement, and requirements should be stated in terms of desired outcomes as opposed to detailed procedures.

4.3 Normal viewing conditions. Normal viewing conditions for the inspection of the women's skirt is 3-feet from the surface being examined. Unless otherwise specified, the women's skirt shall be examined while lying flat on a suitable table using the following illumination criteria. The overhead direct lighting source shall be parallel to the viewing surface so as to illuminate with direct perpendicular impinging light rays. The surface illumination level shall be a minimum of 1075 lux (100-foot candles). The lights shall be cool white preheat rapid start fluorescent lamps with white reflectors and without baffles or glass.

5. DETAILED REQUIREMENTS

5.1 Sampling and acceptance criteria. The sample unit shall be one (1) finished women's skirt and lot size shall be expressed in the number of sample units. The sample size and Acceptance Quality Limit (AQL) shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

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Sampling for inspection shall be conducted in accordance with ASQ/ANSI Z1.4 – Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes Sampling shall represent all types, classes, and styles included in the production lot, and shall include samples from the beginning, middle and end of production of the end-item specification.

5.2 End-item dimensional examination. The finished women's skirt shall be measured for conformance to the finishes measurements as started in end-item specification. The sample size for end-item dimensional examination shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order. .

5.3 End-item visual examination. The skirts shall be examined for the defects stated in Table I of this document. Defects are assigned as "Major" or "Minor". The sample unit shall be one (1) finished skirt.

5.4 Shade variation examination. During the examination, each skirt in the sample shall be examined for shade variation. Any skirt in the sample containing uneven shade or shade variation, within a part or between parts, shall be cause for rejection of entire lot represented by the sample.

5.5 Dimensional examination. During the examination, each skirt in the sample shall be examined for compliance with the dimensions specified in the associated specification.

5.6 Shade match and appearance examination. The shade match and appearance examination shall be conducted as specified in the end-item specification, contract or purchase order.

5.7 Inspection procedures. Sampling for inspection shall be conducted in accordance with ASQ/ANSI Z1.4 – Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes. The inspection level and acceptance quality limits shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful but is not mandatory).

6.1 Intended use. To provide a standardized examination procedure for evaluating quality of skirts that are worn by members of the military as part of dress uniforms. These defects are typical of those included in quality inspections of skirts.

6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this standard
b. Type of material defects allowed.
c. The specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.3)
d. Acceptance Quality Level (AQL) (see 5)

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6.3 Subject term (key word) listing.

Examination
Fabric defect
Inspection

6.4 Changes from previous issue. Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extent of the changes.

Custodians:
Army – GL
Navy – NU
Air Force - 11

Preparing activity:
DLA - CT

(Project: 8410- 2026-005)

Review activities:
Army- MD
Navy – MC

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